



Cloud Security

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1. FCS CLI

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FCS CLI

A command-line tool for image assessment and infrastructure as code scanning.

About the FCS CLI

The FCS CLI is a local tool used for pre-runtime security checks on infrastructure as code (IaC) and container images, helping you shift security left in your development lifecycle.

Overview

The Falcon Cloud Security command line interface (FCS CLI) is a powerful utility that helps you identify and prevent security risks before deployment. This local tool performs pre-runtime security checks on infrastructure as code (IaC) and container images, helping you shift security left in your development lifecycle.

Use the FCS CLI as an ad-hoc tool for local development and testing, or integrate it into your automated workflows. The FCS CLI runs on your Linux, MacOS, or Windows system, and uses OAuth to authenticate seamlessly with the CrowdStrike cloud on your behalf.

The FCS CLI offers:

- **Infrastructure as Code Scanning:** Detect misconfigurations and security risks in IaC templates before deployment
- **Container Image Assessment:** Identify vulnerabilities and security issues in container images
- **CI/CD Integration:** Easily integrate security checks into your development pipeline using our GitHub Action (available in [GitHub Marketplace](#) and as an open source implementation) or create custom integrations using the flexible command-line interface

Requirements

Requirements for the FCS CLI depend on which functionality you plan to use.

- For Image Assessment, see [About Image Assessment with the FCS CLI](#)
- For Infrastructure as Code scanning, see [Set Up IaC](#)

Supported OSes

The Falcon Cloud Security command line interface (FCS CLI) supports the following platforms:

OS	Supported versions
Linux	kernel version 2.6.32 or later
macOS	High Sierra 10.13 or later
Windows	10 or later

Install the FCS CLI

The Falcon Cloud Security command line interface (FCS CLI) is available for Linux, macOS and Windows. The utility is distributed as a compressed tar file.

There are 3 ways to get the FCS CLI:

- Manually download the FCS CLI.
- Programmatically download the tool using a script in the language of your choice. This can help integrate the FCS CLI tool into your CI/CD pipeline. For info, see [Download the FCS CLI programmatically](#).
- Use the Falcon Pull Script to pull the FCS CLI as a container. For info, see [Retrieve Falcon Cloud Security Component Images from the CrowdStrike Registry](#).

These instructions go through the manual download for your first interaction with the FCS CLI. If you prefer to jump directly to one of the other methods, choose a method that works best for you.

Step 1: Manually download the FCS CLI

Choose your platform to download the latest available version of the CLI.

Operating system	Architecture	Platform name	File name
macOS	Apple Silicon	darwin-arm64	fcs_2.2.0_Darwin_arm64.tar.gz
macOS	Intel-based	darwin-amd64	fcs_2.2.0_Darwin_x86_64.tar.gz
Linux	aarch64	linux-arm64	fcs_2.2.0_Linux_arm64.tar.gz
Linux	x86_64	linux-amd64	fcs_2.2.0_Linux_x86_64.tar.gz
Windows	aarch64	windows-arm64	fcs_2.2.0_Windows_arm64.zip
Windows	x86_64	windows-amd64	fcs_2.2.0_Windows_x86_64.zip

To download the FCS CLI through the Falcon console, go to [Support and resources > Resources and tools > Tool downloads](#) . Search for **CLI** or the version number to find the FCS CLI download links.

Tip: If you already have the FCS CLI version 0.42.0 or later, you can use **fcs update** instead of downloading a new binary. For versions 2.1.7 and higher, your API client needs the scope **Cloud Security Tools Download: Read** to use the update command. If you receive an error message stating you're already using the latest version, specify the download version explicitly to resolve the update issue. For example, **fcs update --version 2.1.5**.

Step 2: Extract the FCS CLI and make it executable

The FCS CLI needs to be extracted from the tar file and made executable. The commands to do this vary by platform.

Linux or Mac:

1. Open a Terminal window.
2. If needed, cd to the folder where you downloaded the FCS CLI.
3. Run these commands. If needed, adjust the **chmod** command based on which users should have executable access to the FCS CLI.

```
tar -xvzf fcs*.tar.gz
chmod u+x fcs
```

Windows 10 or Windows 11: Choose one of these two options to extract the file. No additional commands are required to make the file executable.

Option 1 - GUI:

1. Right-click the downloaded zip file and select **Extract All...**
2. Choose a destination folder, then click **Extract**.

Option 2 - PowerShell

1. Open PowerShell.
2. If needed, **cd** to the folder where you downloaded the FCS CLI.
3. Run this command.

```
Expand-Archive -Path fcs*.zip -DestinationPath .
```

Step 3: Optional. Copy the FCS CLI to your path

Command line utilities are easier to use when they're on your path. Choose the process that's right for you and either copy the FCS CLI to a place on your path, or add the current location to the path so that you can access it from anywhere on your computer.

Common locations by operating system:

- For Linux, do one of these:
 - Move **fcs** to **/usr/local/bin** or **/usr/bin**
 - Add the folder for **fcs** to your system's **PATH** variable
- For macOS, do one of these:
 - Intel-based Mac: Move **fcs** to **/usr/local/bin**
 - Apple Silicon: Move **fcs** to **/opt/homebrew/bin**
 - Add the folder for **fcs** to your system's **PATH** variable
- For Windows, do one of these:
 - Move **fcs.exe** to **C:\Windows\System32**
 - Create a new directory for **fcs.exe** and add it to your system's **PATH** variable, for example **C:\Tools**

Configure FCS CLI

Migrate your configuration from older FCS CLI versions

If you have an existing version of the FCS CLI that uses the **fcs_profiles.json** configuration file, when you run any command the FCS CLI automatically detects the old configuration file and offers to migrate the file for you. You can also manually trigger an update with **fcs migrate-config**.

```
Found legacy profiles file. Migrating to the new configuration format is recommended.  
Would you like to migrate your existing profiles? (y/N):
```

The migration process converts your configuration to the new **~/.crowdstrike/fcs.json** and stores a backup of your original file. You can skip the rest of the configuration steps.

Step 1: Create an API client key

You need to authorize the FCS CLI to connect to the CrowdStrike cloud and act on your behalf. Application authorization is done with an OAuth API client key, also known as a client ID and secret.

Tip: Follow the principle of least privilege and create API keys with only the minimum required scopes. This limits potential impact if a key is compromised.

If you do not have the Falcon administrator role, you need a Falcon administrator to help with this step.

1. In the Falcon console, go to **Support and resources > Resources and tools > API clients and keys**.
 2. Click **Add new API client**.
 3. Enter a client name and description. These are for informational purposes only.
 4. For image assessment with the FCS CLI, select the following scopes:
 - o Falcon Container CLI : Read / Write
 - o Falcon Container Image: Read / Write
 5. For Infrastructure as Code scanning with the FCS CLI, and for programmatically downloading the FCS CLI, select the following scopes:
 - o Infrastructure as Code: Read / Write
 6. Click **Add**.
 7. Copy the client ID and secret to a secure location.
- Important: The client secret is not retrievable after the on-screen window is closed.

Step 2: Use the interactive FCS CLI configure tool

The FCS CLI needs your CrowdStrike API credentials. There are three ways you can provide them:

- A built-in FCS CLI configuration tool that saves profiles.
- Command line flags
- Environment variables

To use the configuration tool to set things up:

1. From your command line, run the built-in configuration tool.

```
fcs configure
```

1. Enter your **Falcon Client ID** and **Falcon Client Secret**. For security reasons, the **Falcon Client Secret** is not echoed back to you on screen.
2. Enter your **Falcon Region**. To determine your **Falcon Region**, check the URL you use to access the Falcon console.
 - o **us-1**: https://falcon.crowdstrike.com
 - o **us-2**: https://falcon.us-2.crowdstrike.com
 - o **eu-1**: https://falcon.eu-1.crowdstrike.com
 - o **us-gov-1**: https://falcon.laggar.gcw.crowdstrike.com
 - o **us-gov-2**: https://falcon.us-gov-2.crowdstrike.mil

```
# fcs configure
```

```
=== Falcon Cloud Security CLI Configuration ===
```

```
Creating new configuration file at: /Users/thisuser/.crowdstrike/fcs.json
```

```
Configuring profile 'default':
```

```
Falcon Client ID: aabbccdd...11223344
```

```
Falcon Client Secret:
```

```
Falcon Region [us-1, us-2, eu-1, us-gov-1, us-gov-2]: us-1
```

```
Profile 'default' remains the active profile.
```

```
Configuration updated successfully!
```

You can now use the FCS CLI with the following commands:

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- `fcs scan image` - Scan container images
- `fcs scan iac <path>` - Scan infrastructure as code
- `fcs --help` - Show available commands

Configuration is a one-time process, but you can run it again to override the values entered or to make additional profiles. For more info about profiles, see [Profile management](#).

If you prefer to provide your CrowdStrike API credentials in another way, you can use either our command line flags or environment variables. These methods auto-determine your Falcon region, but you also have the option of providing it.

Command line flag	Environment variable	Description
<code>--client-id</code>	<code>FALCON_CLIENT_ID</code>	The CrowdStrike API client ID. If using <code>--client-id</code> , you must also use <code>--client-secret</code> .
<code>--client-secret</code>	<code>FALCON_CLIENT_SECRET</code>	The CrowdStrike API client secret. If using <code>--client-secret</code> , you must also use <code>--client-id</code> .
<code>--falcon-cloud</code>	<code>FALCON_CLOUD</code>	The Falcon cloud region

For more information, including the order of precedence of these options, see [Advanced FCS CLI configuration options](#).

Basic command structure for FCS CLI

If you prefer to learn hands-on rather than read additional documentation, the FCS CLI follows a logical command structure and is self-documenting.

```
fcs <command> <subcommand> [options]
```

You can substitute **command** with one of the following top-level commands for FCS CLI.

- **configure**: Set up your Falcon API profile
- **scan**: Scan images or Infrastructure as Code (IaC)

Additionally, you can append `--help` or **help** to any command or subcommand for more information.

```
fcs <command> --help
```

For example, requesting help for `fcs configure` shows you that you can configure the FCS CLI interactively, or in a single command providing the flags on the command line.

```
$ fcs configure --help
```

Interactive configuration tool for FCS CLI with your Falcon API credentials and region

Usage:

```
fcs configure [flags]
```

Examples:

```
# Interactive configuration of your FCS CLI profile
fcs configure
```

```
# Configure using specific flags
```

```
fcs configure --client-id CLIENT_ID --client-secret CLIENT_SECRET --falcon-cloud us-1
```

For more information about precedence of command-line parameters vs your configuration file, and how to configure multiple profiles for FCS CLI, see [Advanced FCS CLI configuration options](#).

What's next?

- Command line Image assessment:
 - Install and configure the FCS CLI
 - Assess images with the FCS CLI
- Command line infrastructure as code (IaC)
 - Set Up IaC
 - Scanning using CLI parameters
 - Scanning using configuration files
- Integrate into your CI/CD pipeline
 - Integrate into your CI/CD pipeline
 - Scanning IaC files through a CI/CD pipeline using the FCS CLI container target

Manage the FCS CLI

Discover how to update the FCS CLI and use advanced FCS CLI configuration options. Includes global references and troubleshooting.

The FCS CLI is a command line utility used for ad-hoc and scripted image assessment and infrastructure as code (IaC) tasks. Learn how to update it and use some of the more advanced features.

Update the FCS CLI

Starting with release 0.42.0, you can use the FCS CLI's built-in update command to update to the latest version. For versions 2.1.7 and higher, your API client needs the scope **Cloud Security Tools Download: Read** to use the update command.

fcs update

Note: If you receive an error message stating you're already using the latest version, specify the download version explicitly to resolve the update issue. For example, **fcs update --version 2.1.7**.

By default, the **update** command updates to the latest version. If you want to update to a specific version, use the **--version** flag.

fcs update --version x.y.z

You can also programmatically check for the latest version and download it. For more info, see [Download the FCS CLI programmatically](#).

Advanced FCS CLI configuration options

Profile management

The FCS CLI can maintain multiple profiles for you with different settings. For example, you can set up a profile for pre-release testing where the results are not made available through the Falcon console, and another for production that makes the results available through the Falcon console.

To view your current profiles, and optionally edit each one:

fcs configure list

For example:

```
$ fcs configure list
=== Falcon Cloud Security CLI Configuration ===
Found existing configuration file at: /Users/username/.crowdstrike/fcs.json
```


Configuring profile 'default':

Profile 'default' already exists. Current settings:

- Falcon Region: us-1
- Client ID: aabbccdd*****
- Client Secret: 12aa23bb*****
- Custom Domains:
 - API: https://api.crowdstrike.com
 - Container Upload: https://container-upload.us-1.crowdstrike.com
 - Image Assessment: https://container-upload.us-1.crowdstrike.com

Do you want to update this profile? (Y/n):

Create a new profile

To create a new profile:

1. Run configure with the `--profile` command flag.

```
fcs configure --profile <profile_name>
```

For example:

```
fcs configure --profile production
```

Specify which profile to use

To use one of your saved profiles when running an FCS CLI command:

1. Use the `--profile` command flag to your command.

```
fcs --profile <profile_name> scan image <image_identifier>
```

For example:

```
fcs --profile production scan image nginx:latest
```

Or, to tell the FCS CLI that you always want monochrome output:

1. Set the `FCS_PROFILE` environment variable to the name of one of your stored profiles:

```
export FCS_PROFILE="<my-profile-name>"
```

As long as the environment variable is set, that profile is used for all FCS CLI commands unless you specify a different profile on the command line.

Override profile values

Although your profiles specify default configuration values for your FCS CLI commands, you can also override them. There are three different levels of configuration you can use, and they are evaluated in the following order of precedence.

1. Command line flags / arguments
2. Environment variables
3. Default or named profile values

If your profile uses a particular CrowdStrike client ID and secret, but you specify different ones as arguments to the command line, the command line values take precedence over the values in your profile.

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The FCS CLI understands the following profile-related command line flags and environment variables:

Command line flag	Environment variable	Description
<code>--client-id</code>	<code>FALCON_CLIENT_ID</code>	The CrowdStrike API client ID. If using <code>--client-id</code> , you must also use <code>--client-secret</code> .
<code>--client-secret</code>	<code>FALCON_CLIENT_SECRET</code>	The CrowdStrike API client secret. If using <code>--client-secret</code> , you must also use <code>--client-id</code> .
<code>--falcon-cloud</code> or <code>--falcon-region</code>	<code>FALCON_CLOUD</code>	The Falcon cloud (use of <code>--falcon-region</code> is deprecated)

For a complete list of supported environment variables, see [FCS CLI supported environment variables](#).

Download the FCS CLI programmatically

To use the FCS CLI in an automated process, you might want to download the latest version programmatically.

FCS CSI supported platforms and filenames

The following table lists the supported platforms and related platform name and file name you need for downloading.

Operating system	Architecture	Platform name	File name
macOS	Apple Silicon	darwin-arm64	fcs_2.2.0_Darwin_arm64.tar.gz
macOS	Intel-based	darwin-amd64	fcs_2.2.0_Darwin_x86_64.tar.gz
Linux	aarch64	linux-arm64	fcs_2.2.0_Linux_arm64.tar.gz
Linux	x86_64	linux-amd64	fcs_2.2.0_Linux_x86_64.tar.gz
Windows	aarch64	windows-arm64	fcs_2.2.0_Windows_arm64.zip
Windows	x86_64	windows-amd64	fcs_2.2.0_Windows_x86_64.zip

Prerequisites

Before retrieving Falcon Cloud Security images, ensure you have an active CrowdStrike subscription and the required command-line utilities installed in your environment.

The following items are required to retrieve Falcon Cloud Security product images:

- An active CrowdStrike subscription with appropriate entitlements
- Command-line utilities:
 - `jq`
 - `curl` (version 7.55.0 or later recommended for security)

Step 1: Create an API client key

Create an API client in the Falcon console to obtain the credentials required for authenticating to CrowdStrike and retrieving security images.

1. In the Falcon console, go to **Support and resources > Resources and tools > API clients and keys**.
2. Click **Add new API client**.
3. Enter a client name and description.
4. Select the API following scopes:

Scope	Permission	Required
Cloud Security Tools Download	Read	Always
Infrastructure as Code	Read / Write	For IaC scanning only
Falcon Container CLI	Read / Write	For Image scanning only
Falcon Container Image	Read / Write	For Image scanning only

5. Click **Add**.
6. Copy the client ID and secret to a secure location.
7. Set environment variables:

```
export FCS_CLIENT_ID=<YOUR_FCS_CLIENT_ID>
export FCS_CLIENT_SECRET=<YOUR_FCS_CLIENT_SECRET>
export FALCON_API_URL=<YOUR_BASE_URL>
```

Your API base url is provided on the API clients page, but if you missed it there, use this table to find the host name that corresponds with your CrowdStrike cloud.

Cloud	API base URL
US-1	https://api.crowdstrike.com
US-2	https://api.us-2.crowdstrike.com
EU-1	https://api.eu-1.crowdstrike.com
US-GOV-1	https://api.laggar.gcw.crowdstrike.com
US-GOV-2	https://api.us-gov-2.crowdstrike.mil

Step 2: Get an auth token

1. Retrieve an auth token. For info, see [Get an auth token](#).

For example:

```
curl --request POST \
  --header "Content-Type: application/x-www-form-urlencoded" \
  --data-urlencode "client_id=${FALCON_CLIENT_ID}" \
  --data-urlencode "client_secret=${FALCON_CLIENT_SECRET}" \
  --url "${FALCON_API_URL}/oauth2/token"
```

2. From the response, find the **access_token** and save it.

```
FALCON_ACCESS_TOKEN="aabbcc...112233"
```

Or, when you make the call, you can use `jq` to save the value directly:

```
FALCON_ACCESS_TOKEN=$(curl --request POST \
  --header "Content-Type: application/x-www-form-urlencoded" \
  --data-urlencode "client_id=${FALCON_CLIENT_ID}" \
  --data-urlencode "client_secret=${FALCON_CLIENT_SECRET}" \
  --url "${FALCON_API_URL}/oauth2/token" | jq -r '.access_token')
```

Step 3: Enumerate available versions

1. Decide which target OS and architecture you want and set appropriate environment variables. Use your chosen `os_name` and `arch_name`.

Note: If you're unsure how to set `FCS_TARGET_OS` and `FCS_TARGET_ARCH`, call the API with these environment variables unset to see all available values. You can also review the Platform name column from the FCS CLI Manual download instructions. Platform names have the format `<os_name>--<arch_name>`.

```
FCS_TARGET_OS=<os_name>
FCS_TARGET_ARCH=<arch_name>
```

2. Call the API endpoint.

```
curl --get \
  --header 'accept: application/json' \
  --header "Authorization: Bearer ${FALCON_ACCESS_TOKEN}" \
  --url "${FALCON_API_URL}/csdownloads/combined/files-download/v2" \
  --data-urlencode
"filter=category:\"fcs\"+os:\"${FCS_TARGET_OS}\"+arch:\"${FCS_TARGET_ARCH}\"" | \
jq '.resources[] | {file_name, file_version, file_hash, download_url:
.download_info.download_url}'
```

3. The `jq` command at the end of this API call provides a JSON formatted list of available filenames, file versions, file hashes, and download URLs for your specified target OS and architecture.

```
{
  "file_name": "file-name",
  "file_version": "1.x.x",
  "file_hash": "abcdabcdabcd...abcd",
  "download_url": "url-value"
}
```

For example, to get a list of versions of the FCS CLI that work on Apple silicon, set your target OS and architecture:

```
FCS_TARGET_OS=darwin
FCS_TARGET_ARCH=arm64
```

If you don't specify the OS or architecture names, the list returns the available FCS CLI downloads for all platforms.

Step 4: Download the file

Use the download URL from the previous response to download your file.

1. Use the selected filename, or specify a name you would like to use when saving the file, then download the FCS CLI file.

```
FCS_CLI_LINK="<download_url>"
FCS_FILENAME="<selected_filename>"
```

```
curl --location --output ${FCS_FILENAME} ${FCS_CLI_LINK}
```

2. After download, compare the file's hash with the expected value.

```
sha256 $FCS_FILENAME
```

Troubleshooting

Common Issues

Timeout issues

Error details: context deadline exceeded

- Check that the image file is accessible from your container runtime. Try to pull the image directly.
- Use `--timeout` to increase the timeout in seconds from the default 5 mins (300) to 10 minutes (600), or more.

Authentication Errors

Error: API key validation failed, either the API credentials are not valid or there was an error. Forbidden: You Do not have the required permissions to access this resource

- Verify your Client ID and Secret. Step 1: Manually download the FCS CLI
- Check your region setting.
- Ensure your subscription is active.

Debugging

Enable verbose output for troubleshooting:

```
fcs --verbose scan image nginx:latest
```

Image scanning errors

Use the Scan Errors section of the on-screen or saved report for details about any image scanning issues. For example:

△ Scan Errors

TYPE	MESSAGE	TIMESTAMP	TRACE ID
vulnerability_assessment	Failed to assess vulnerabilities	2025-08-21T17:44:16Z	aabb-ccdd...1122

FCS CLI global command line options

These flags can be applied to most FCS CLI commands:

Flag	Type	Description
<code>--client-id</code>	string	CrowdStrike API client ID (overrides your profile value)

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Flag	Type	Description
<code>--client-secret</code>	string	CrowdStrike API client secret (overrides your profile value)
<code>--falcon-region</code>	string	Falcon cloud region (us-1, us-2, eu-1, us-gov-1, us-gov-2)
<code>--help, -h</code>	-	Display help for any command
<code>--output</code>	string	Output format (json, sarif, etc)
<code>--profile</code>	string	Use a specific named profile from configuration
<code>--verbose, -v</code>	boolean	Enable verbose logging

FCS CLI supported environment variables

The FCS CLI accepts input from the command line, saved configurations, and from environment variables.

Input is evaluated in the following order of precedence.

1. Command line flags / arguments
2. Environment variables
3. Default or named profile values

Meaning that even if you have an environment variable set, if you specify the same value on the command line, the command line value takes precedence.

FCS CLI supports the following global environment variables. For image scanning variable, see Image scan command options.

Environment variable	Description
<code>FALCON_CLIENT_ID</code>	CrowdStrike API client ID
<code>FALCON_CLIENT_SECRET</code>	CrowdStrike API client secret
<code>FALCON_CLOUD</code>	Falcon cloud region
<code>FCS_PROFILE</code>	Named profile to use
<code>FCS_TIMEOUT</code>	Timeout, in seconds, for operations.
<code>FCS_VERBOSE</code>	Enable verbose logging (set to "true")
<code>XDG_CONFIG_HOME</code>	User config directory (Linux/macOS)
Your container runtime's socket environment variable. For example, <code>DOCKER_HOST</code> for Docker.	To specify a non-default container runtime socket.